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### Mattress assembly

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#### Abstract

A mattress assembly includes a cover, a spring pack positioned within the cover, and an inner core positioned within the cover. The inner core includes opposite first and second portions. The first portion has a firmness that is different than a firmness of the second portion. The inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the spring pack and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the spring pack to alter a firmness of a sleep surface of the mattress. Methods of use are disclosed.

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## Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/177,949, filed on Nov. 1, 2018, which is expressly incorporated by reference herein, in its entirety.

### TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to mattresses, and more particularly to mattress assemblies that include a dual-side mattress having two different comfort choices.

### BACKGROUND

(2) Sleep is critical for people to feel and perform their best, in every aspect of their lives. Sleep is an essential path to better health and reaching personal goals. Indeed, sleep affects everything from the ability to commit new information to memory to weight gain. It is therefore essential for people to use bedding that suit both their personal sleep preference and body type in order to achieve comfortable, restful sleep.

(3) Infants and toddlers often require firmer mattresses than older children. In order to prevent having to purchase a new mattress when children become older, some mattresses include a first side having a firmness that is suited for toddlers and a second side having a firmness that is suited for older children. In that young children are likely to wet the bed, such mattresses may include a waterproof cover to prevent urine from getting into the mattress. However, such waterproof covers

prevent body heat from ventilating through the mattress and are hence uncomfortable to sleep on. Furthermore, conventional mattresses typically include a cover that is sewn onto an inner core of the mattress, thus requiring that the cover be flipped when the mattress is flipped. This disclosure describes an improvement over these prior art technologies.

## SUMMARY

(4) In one embodiment, in accordance with the principles of the present disclosure, a mattress assembly is provided that includes a cover, a spring pack positioned within the cover, and an inner core positioned within the cover. The inner core includes opposite first and second portions. The first portion has a firmness that is different than a firmness of the second portion. The inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the spring pack and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the spring pack to alter a firmness of a sleep surface of the mattress.

(5) In one embodiment, in accordance with the principles of the present disclosure, a mattress assembly is provided that includes a cover, a spring pack positioned within the cover, and an inner core positioned within the cover. The cover comprises a porous, non-waterproof material and a zipper. The spring pack comprises opposite first and second surfaces and a plurality of springs positioned between the first and second surfaces. The first surface defines a waterproof barrier. The inner core comprises a matrix of polyurethane fibers. The matrix comprises opposite first and second portions. The fibers that make up the first portion are more densely packed than the fibers that make up the second portion such that the first portion has a firmness that is greater than a firmness of the second portion. The inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the waterproof barrier and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the waterproof barrier to alter a firmness of a sleep surface of the mattress.

(6) In one embodiment, in accordance with the principles of the present disclosure, a mattress assembly is provided that includes a cover, a spring pack positioned within the cover, and an inner core positioned within the cover. The cover comprises a porous, non-waterproof material and a zipper. The spring pack comprises opposite first and second surfaces and a plurality of springs positioned between the first and second surfaces. The first surface defines a waterproof barrier. The inner core comprises a mat of electrospun polyurethane fibers. The mat comprises opposite first and second portions. The fibers that make up the first portion are more densely packed than the fibers that make up the second portion such that the first portion has a firmness that is greater than a firmness of the second portion. The inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the waterproof barrier and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the waterproof barrier to alter a firmness of a sleep surface of the mattress.

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## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The present disclosure will become more readily apparent from the specific description accompanied by the following drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of one embodiment of a mattress assembly in accordance with the present principles of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a cross sectional view of the mattress assembly shown in FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3 is a perspective view of components of the mattress assembly shown in FIG. 1;

(5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of components of the mattress assembly shown in FIG. 1;

(6) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of components of the mattress assembly shown in FIG. 1;

(7) FIG. 6 is a perspective view of a component of the mattress assembly shown in FIG. 1; and

(8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a component of the mattress assembly shown in FIG. 1.

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) The exemplary embodiments are discussed in terms of mattresses, such as, for example, mattress assemblies that include a dual-side inner core having two different comfort choices. The present disclosure may be understood more readily by reference to the following detailed description of the disclosure. It is to be understood that this disclosure is not limited to the specific devices, methods, conditions or parameters described and/or shown herein, and that the terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments by way of example only and is not intended to be limiting of the claimed disclosure.

(10) Also, as used in the specification and including the appended claims, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include the plural, and reference to a particular numerical value includes at least that particular value, unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Ranges may be expressed herein as from “about” or “approximately” one particular value and/or to “about” or “approximately” another particular value. When such a range is expressed, another embodiment includes from the one particular value and/or to the other particular value. Similarly, when values are expressed as approximations, by use of the antecedent “about,” it will be understood that the particular value forms another embodiment. It is also understood that all spatial references, such as, for example, horizontal, vertical, top, upper, lower, bottom, left and right, are for illustrative purposes only and can be varied within the scope of the disclosure. For example, the references “upper” and “lower” or “top” and “bottom” are relative and used only in the context to the other, and are not necessarily “superior” and “inferior”.

(11) The following discussion includes a description of a mattress assembly **10**. Alternate embodiments are also disclosed. Reference will now be made in detail to the exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure.

(12) The components of mattress assembly **10** can be fabricated from materials including metals, synthetic polymers, ceramics and/or their composites, depending on the particular application and/or preference. For example, the components of mattress assembly **10**, individually or collectively, can be fabricated from materials such as stainless steel alloys, aluminum, commercially pure titanium, titanium alloys, Grade 5 titanium, super-elastic titanium alloys, cobalt-chrome alloys, stainless steel alloys, superelastic metallic alloys (e.g., Nitinol, super elasto-plastic metals, such as GUM METAL® manufactured by Toyota Material Incorporated of Japan), ceramics, thermoplastics such as polyaryletherketone (PAEK) including polyetheretherketone (PEEK), polyetherketoneketone (PEKK) and polyetherketone (PEK), carbon-PEEK composites, PEEK-BaSO<sub>4</sub> polymeric rubbers, polyethylene terephthalate (PET), fabric, silicone, polyurethane, silicone-polyurethane copolymers, polymeric rubbers, polyolefin rubbers, hydrogels, semi-rigid and rigid materials, elastomers, rubbers, thermoplastic elastomers, thermoset elastomers, elastomeric composites, rigid polymers including polyphenylene, polyamide, polyimide, polyetherimide, polyethylene, and epoxy. Mattress assembly **10** may be made from materials such as, for example, one or more of cotton, kapok, flax, linen, jute, ramie, hemp, kenaf, bamboo, coir, sisal, silk, wool (sheep), alpaca, llama, goat (mohair, cashmere), rabbit (angora), camel, horse, yak, vicuna, qiviut, guanaco, rayon, azlon, lyocell, acetate, triacetate, rubber, polyester, olefin, nylon, acrylic, modacrylic, aramid, spandex. Mattress assembly **10** is made such that mattress assembly **10** is compliant with all U.S. Federal Mattress Regulations, such as, for example, 16 C.F.R. §§ 1632 and 1633. Various components of mattress assembly **10** may have material composites, including the above materials, to achieve various desired characteristics such as strength, rigidity, elasticity, compliance, mechanical performance, and durability. The components of mattress assembly **10**, individually or collectively, may also be fabricated from a heterogeneous material such as a combination of two or more of the above-described materials. The components of mattress assembly **10** may be monolithically formed, integrally connected or include fastening elements and/or instruments, as described herein.

(13) Mattress assembly **10** includes a cover **12** that defines a pocket **14**. In some embodiments, cover **12** includes only one pocket, such as, for example, pocket **14**. In some embodiments, cover **12** includes a plurality of discrete pockets. In some embodiments, cover **12** includes a fastener, such as, for example, a zipper **16** to provide access to pocket **14**. In some embodiments, cover **12** comprises a porous material, such as, for example, a porous fabric that allows air to move in and out of pocket through cover **12**. In some embodiments, cover **12** comprises a breathable material, such as, for example, a breathable fabric that allows air to move in and out of pocket through cover **12**. In some embodiments, cover **12** is made entirely of a porous material and/or a breathable material. That is, no portion of cover **12** is waterproof. In some embodiments, cover **12** is washable. That is, cover **12** is configured to be washed in a standard washing machine.

(14) One or a plurality of spring packs **18** is/are positioned within pocket **14**. Spring pack **18** comprises a plurality of springs **20** positioned within a pouch **22**. Springs **20** are enclosed within pouch **22**. Spring pack **18** comprises one or a plurality of rows of springs **20** and one or a plurality of columns of springs **20**. In some embodiments, spring pack **18** includes a plurality of rows of springs **20** and a plurality of columns of springs **20**. In some embodiments, spring pack **18** includes a plurality of strings of springs, as described in U.S. Patent Application No. 62/347,199 to the inventor of the current application, which is incorporated by reference herein, in its entirety. In some embodiments, springs **20** are each positioned within a pocket, such as, for example, a fabric pocket. The pockets may be coupled to one another to form a string of pockets that each include one of springs **20** therein. In some embodiments, the string of pockets includes one or more slits between adjacent pockets to allow springs **20** to move independently of one another. In some embodiments, the string of pockets includes one or more slits that extend through a top surface of the string of pockets between adjacent pockets and/or one or more slits that extend through a bottom surface of the string of pockets between adjacent pockets. In some embodiments, spring pack **18** is permanently fixed to cover **12**. In some embodiments, spring pack **18** is removably disposed within pocket **14**.

(15) Pouch **22** includes a bottom surface that directly engages cover **12** and an opposite top surface **24**. Springs **20** are positioned between the bottom surface of pouch **22** and surface **24**. In some embodiments, surface **24** comprises a waterproof material such that surface **24** defines a waterproof barrier of pouch **22** that prevents liquids from passing through surface **24** to prevent liquids or moisture from entering pouch **22** through surface **24**. In some embodiments, surface **24** is entirely waterproof. That is, the entire area of surface **24** that is defined by the perimeter of surface **24** is waterproof. In some embodiments, surface **24** is non-porous. In some embodiments, surface **24** comprises a waterproof fabric. In some embodiments, surface **24** comprises a waterproof polymer. In some embodiments, surface **24** comprises a thermoplastic polyurethane. In some embodiments, surface **24** comprises a thermoplastic polyurethane breathable waterproof fabric. In some embodiments, surface **24** comprises a porous fabric that is coated with a waterproof material.

(16) In some embodiments, mattress assembly **10** does not include any springs, such as, for example, spring pack **18**. In some embodiments, mattress assembly **10** includes a material, such as, for example, a foam block in place of spring pack **18**.

(17) An inner core **26** is removably positioned within pocket **14** such that core **26** directly engages surface **24** of spring pack **18**. Core **26** includes opposite first and second portions **28**, **30** and a middle portion **32** between portions **28**, **30**. Portion **28** has a firmness that is different than a firmness of portion **30** to provide two different comfort choices. For example, core **26** can include a firmer side for toddlers and a softer side for tweens. In some embodiments, portion **32** has a firmness that is less than a firmness of portion **28** and a firmness of portion **30**. Core **26** can be flipped as the child grows to prevent the need to buy another mattress as the child ages. For example, the same mattress can be used from when the child is 2 or 3 years old until the child is 12 or 13 years old. Core **26** is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which portion **28** directly engages surface **24** of spring pack **18** and a second configuration in which portion **30**

directly engages surface **24** to alter a firmness of a sleep surface **34** of mattress assembly **10**.

(18) In some embodiments, core **26** comprises a matrix of fibers. The fibers that make up portion **28** are more densely packed than the fibers that make up portion **30** such that portion **28** is firmer than portion **30**. In some embodiments, the fibers are made from a polymer, such as, for example, polyurethane. In some embodiments, core **26** consists of the fibers. That is, core **26** does not include any material or components other than the fibers. In some embodiments, core **26** comprises a mat of electrospun fibers. A first side of core **26** that defines portion **28** and a second side of core **26** that defines portion **30** are heat pressed to provide portions **28**, **30** with selected firmnesses. In some embodiments, portion **28** is heat pressed for a longer duration of time and/or at a higher temperature than portion **30** to make portion **28** firmer than portion **30**. In some embodiments, core **26** is washable. That is, core **26** is configured to be washed using water to remove any urine or other material on the fibers that make up core **26**. In some embodiments, core **26** is free of any foam.

(19) In operation and use, core **26** may be positioned within pocket **14** such that portion **30** directly engages surface **24** of spring pack **18** and portion **28** is positioned adjacent to sleep surface **34** of mattress assembly **10** to provide sleep surface **34** with a firmness sufficient to accommodate infants or toddlers. If the infant or toddler should wet the bed, the urine will move through cover **12** and core **26** and onto surface **24** of spring pack **18**. To clean mattress assembly **10**, zipper **16** of cover **12** can be moved from a closed configuration to an open configuration. Spring pack **18** and core **26** may be removed from pocket **14** when zipper **16** is in the open configuration. Cover **12** may be cleaned in a standard washing machine, for example. Spring pack **18** may be cleaned by wiping any urine off of surface **24**. A cleaning material, such as, for example, bleach or vinegar may be applied to surface **24** before surface **24** is wiped clean. Core **26** may be cleaned by rinsing core **26** with water, for example. After cover **12**, spring pack **18** and core **26** are cleaned, spring pack **18** may be repositioned within pocket **14**. Core **26** is then inserted into pocket **14** such that portion **30** directly engages surface **24** of spring pack **18** and portion **28** is positioned adjacent to sleep surface **34** of mattress assembly **10**. Zipper **16** is then moved from the open configuration to the closed configuration.

(20) As the infant or toddler ages, he or she may desire that sleep surface **34** be less firm. To alter the firmness of sleep surface **34**, zipper **16** of cover **12** can be moved from the closed configuration to the open configuration. Core **26** is removed from pocket **14** when zipper **16** is in the open configuration. Core **26** is flipped and is repositioned within pocket such that portion **28** directly engages surface **24** of spring pack **18** and portion **30** is positioned adjacent to sleep surface **34** of mattress assembly **10** to provide sleep surface **34** with a firmness sufficient to accommodate older children. In some embodiments, spring pack **18** remains within pocket **14** while core **26** is being flipped. That is, cover **12** and spring pack **18** are not flipped to alter the firmness of sleep surface **34**. Rather, only core **26** is flipped, while cover **12** and spring pack **18** remain stationary. Should mattress assembly **10** become soiled, spring pack **18** and core **26** may be removed from pocket **14** and cover **12**, spring pack **18** and/or core **26** may be cleaned, as discussed herein. After cover **12**, spring pack **18** and/or core **26** is/are cleaned, spring pack **18** and core **26** may be repositioned within pocket **14**, as discussed herein.

(21) It will be understood that various modifications may be made to the embodiments disclosed herein. For example, features of any one embodiment can be combined with features of any other embodiment. Therefore, the above description should not be construed as limiting, but merely as exemplification of the various embodiments. Those skilled in the art will envision other modifications within the scope and spirit of the claims appended hereto.

## Claims

1. A mattress comprising: a cover defining a pocket and comprising opposite top and bottom walls, an outer surface of the top wall defining a sleep surface, the cover being made from a breathable material to allow air to move in and out of the pocket through the top and bottom walls; and an inner core removably positioned within the cover, the inner core comprising opposite first and second portions, the first portion having a firmness that is greater than a firmness of the second portion, wherein the inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the top wall and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the top wall to alter a firmness of the sleep surface, wherein the second portion directly engages the bottom wall when the inner core is in the first configuration and the first portion directly engages the bottom wall when the inner core is in the second configuration, and wherein the mattress further comprises a waterproof barrier positioned between the cover and the inner core such that the second portion of the inner core directly engages the waterproof barrier when the inner core is in the first configuration and the first portion directly engages the waterproof barrier when the inner core is in the second configuration.
2. The mattress recited in claim 1, further comprising a support positioned between the waterproof barrier and the bottom surface of the cover.
3. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the inner core comprises a matrix of fibers, the fibers that make up the first portion being more densely packed than the fibers that make up the second portion.
4. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the wherein the inner core comprises a matrix of polyurethane fibers, the fibers that make up the first portion being more densely packed than the fibers that make up the second portion.
5. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the inner core comprises a mat of electrospun fibers.
6. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the inner core comprises a mat of electrospun polymer fibers.
7. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the waterproof barrier is coated with a waterproof material.
8. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the waterproof barrier comprises a thermoplastic polyurethane.
9. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the cover includes a fastener to allow the inner core to be removed from the cover.
10. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the cover includes a zipper to allow the inner core to be removed from the cover.
11. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the mattress is free of springs.
12. The mattress recited in claim 2, wherein the support is springs or foam material.
13. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the inner core comprises a foam.
14. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the cover includes a top section and a bottom section, the bottom section being coupled to the top section by a fastener.
15. The mattress recited in claim 1, wherein the cover includes a top section and a bottom section, the bottom section being coupled to the top section by a zipper.
16. A mattress comprising: a cover defining a pocket and comprising opposite top and bottom walls, an outer surface of the top wall defining a sleep surface, the cover being made from a breathable material to allow air to move in and out of the pocket through the top and bottom walls; an inner core removably positioned within the cover, the inner core comprising a mat of fibers having opposite first and second portions, the first portion having a firmness that is greater than a firmness of the second portion; and a waterproof barrier positioned between the cover and the inner core; wherein the inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the top wall and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the top wall to alter a firmness of the sleep surface, wherein the second portion



- directly engages the waterproof barrier when the inner core is in the first configuration and the first portion directly engages the waterproof barrier when the inner core is in the second configuration.
17. A mattress consisting of: a cover defining a pocket and comprising opposite top and bottom walls, an outer surface of the top wall defining a sleep surface, the cover being made from a breathable material to allow air to move in and out of the pocket through the top and bottom walls; an inner core removably positioned within the cover, the inner core comprising a mat of fibers, the mat defining opposite first and second portions, the first portion having a firmness that is greater than a firmness of the second portion; and a support positioned between the inner core and the bottom wall of the cover comprising opposite first and second surfaces, the first surface defining a waterproof barrier, wherein the inner core is configured to be moved between a first configuration in which the first portion directly engages the top wall of the cover and a second configuration in which the second portion directly engages the top wall of the cover to alter a firmness of the sleep surface, and wherein the second portion directly engages the first surface of the support when the inner core is in the first configuration and the first portion directly engages the first surface of the support when the inner core is in the second configuration.
18. The mattress recited in claim 17, wherein the first surface of the support defining a waterproof barrier prevents liquids from passing through said surface.
19. The mattress recited in claim 17, wherein the support comprises a spring pack.
20. The mattress recited in claim 17, wherein the support comprises a foam mass.
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